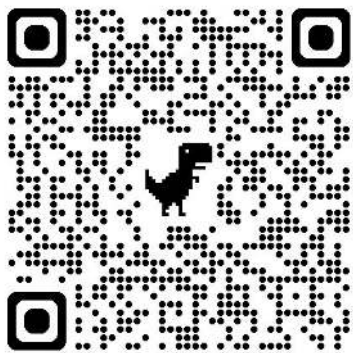
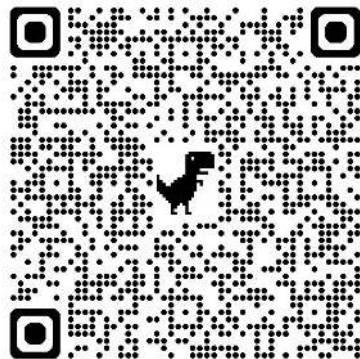


Tow Operators Briefing 2026



Sign in



Documentation

(Download and read this after)



What's new?

Since last season, the team has been hard at work refining our processes and procedures, as well as dumping a ton of time into the improved tow infrastructure.

“What does this mean for me?”

- New tow engine and control system
- Refined training program for the tow
- Different paperwork for you to complete

What hasn't changed:

- Our commitment to safety, regulatory compliance and participant fun!



Training Levels & Responsibilities

Tow Operator

- Responsible for completing most of the activities, and at the end of each activity, and completing the activity.
- Responsible for ensuring compliance with "TOW" documentation, and ensuring compliance with the Tow Training Program and the Tow Training Program.
- Responsible for ensuring the safety of the tow system and the participants.
- Responsible for ensuring the safety of the tow system and the participants.

Tow Supervisor

- Responsible for ensuring the safety of the tow system and the participants.
- Responsible for ensuring the safety of the tow system and the participants.
- Responsible for ensuring the safety of the tow system and the participants.
- Responsible for ensuring the safety of the tow system and the participants.

Tow Trained User

- Responsible for ensuring the safety of the tow system and the participants.
- Responsible for ensuring the safety of the tow system and the participants.
- Responsible for ensuring the safety of the tow system and the participants.
- Responsible for ensuring the safety of the tow system and the participants.



Why are we having a briefing?

-> Ensure we're compliant

- We comply with AS 4722:2024 and Canadian Standard Z98:19

Whilst not required, we also look to the NZ standards to assist with implementation



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We're special

We are one of three places with Nutcrackers remaining in Australia

- Us
- Wangaratta Ski Club (near Hotham)
- Mt Mawson (Tasmania)

To ensure we're doing best practice, we have visited Wang Ski Club and learned from each other



SIGN IN!!



Overview

Competencies, training
and briefings

Usage limitations

Signage

Safety checks

Tow Leaders Report

Current operational state



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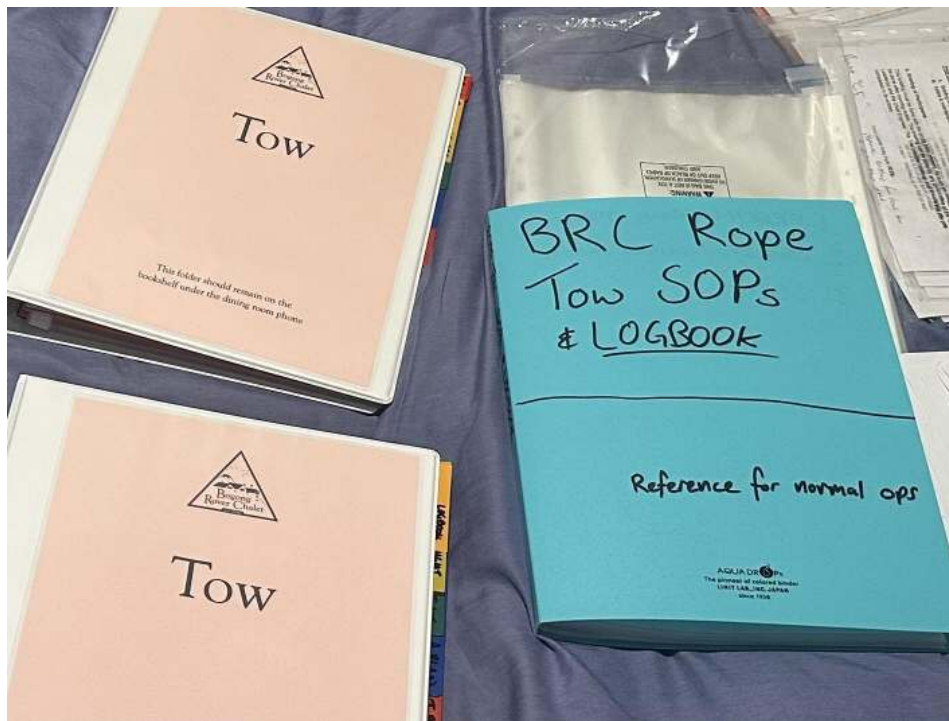
Documentation

Risk assessments & Activity Plans:

- Website
- Email signature block
- Participant Info Pack

Tow documentation

- Blue SOPs and Logbook folder
- Pink master folder
 - Under the dining room phone
 - In the tow hut on the bench



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BRC Rope Tow Training Program

New in 2026, we're introducing a new training program in line with the new training levels established since 2025.

Important changes:

- Clear distinction between Tow Supervisors and Tow Trained Users
- One single Tow Leader in a week who delegates designation of Tow Operators and Tow Supervisors when the Tow is in use
- A new Training Program document to assist

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Tow Training Hierarchy

At-a-glance

Refer to *BRC Rope Tow Training Program* document



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BRC Rope Tow Training Program ...how does it work in practise?

Training levels

- Tow Operator
 - Responsible for operational checks, regulatory and SOP compliance
 - Authorised to start the tow engine.
 - Can be the Tow Leader, manage Rope Tow training and deliver briefings
- Tow Supervisor
 - Deliver the Tow Supervisor Training Brief to upskill Tow Trained Users.
 - Monitors for hazards and incidents, coordinates 1st Aid
 - Mentors novice users, Supervises loading and unloading points.
- Tow Trained User
 - Has an awesome time.

Tow Leaders and designated positions

- Tow Leader
 - Coordinates who takes on the other designated positions each day in fairness
 - Manages tow training
 - Responsible for the completion of reports and logbooks
- Designated Tow Operator
 - Fulfils the Tow Operator job for the time period set by the Tow Leader
- Designated Tow Supervisor
 - Fulfils the Tow Supervisor job for the time period set by the Tow Leader

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Competencies

We are required to (under CSA Z98:2019) demonstrate that we have assessed competency

Prior to week: you'll get a list of people and their current competency (a mix of self-determined and recorded data). You may print this list or keep it on your phone.

After week: The Tow Leader's report contains a section where the competencies and training conducted for each member must be recorded. You can also suggest a demotion if required.

If in doubt, take a video

- Chief Warden has the final say

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The Hierarchy of Responsibility provided assists in illustrating the requirements for each member managing the Rope Tow.

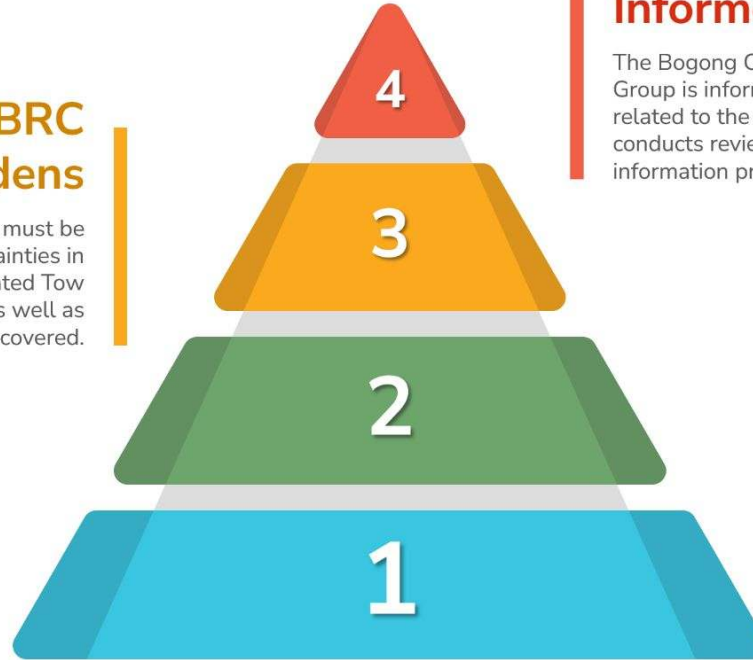
Hierarchy of Responsibility

Consulted – BRC Wardens

The BRC Wardens team must be consulted with any uncertainties in the requirements of Designated Tow Operator and Tow Leader, as well as any anomalies discovered.

Responsible – Designated Tow Operator

The Designated Tow Operator bears responsibility for the safety checks and integrity of the Rope Tow systems.



Informed - BCMG

The Bogong Chalet Management Group is informed of any issues related to the BRC Rope Tow, and conducts reviews based on information provided.

Accountable – Tow Leader

The Tow Leader bears accountability for the completion of tasks required by the Tow Operator. They must ensure that their Designated Tow Operator completes the daily setup and safety checks required of them and the documentation is completed. The Tow Leader reports this information in their report.

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Tow briefing to all participants

- Provided in the *BRC Rope Tow Training Program* document in the folder
 1. Must be done with the whole party present
 - a. Suggested post morning duties parade
 2. Must be done prior to first use of the tow for the week

The briefing can be done by either the Tow Leader or a designated Tow Operator

- Read out the information provided in the pink folder and demonstrate technique

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Briefing points that must be covered to the whole party (1/3)

- What is a rope tow?
 - Participants should log experience in their personal logbooks.
- Nutcracker attachment belt technical information and practises.
 - Safe storage of the nutcracker device on the attachment belt while skiing in order to prevent injury when falling - tucked into the side of the hip.
 - The failsafe aspect and nuance/method of using the nutcracker attachment belt, emphasising “it is okay to just let go”.
 - How to navigate the rope sheaves and other obstacles while riding the tow (just guide the nutcracker through it).
 - “Unapproved harnesses or use of damaged nutcracker harnesses is strictly prohibited on the BRC Rope Tow”
- “There is a requirement under BRC policy for all BRC Rope Tow Users to ski in control at all times and not conduct themselves in such a manner that poses any hazard to others.”
 - The importance and strict requirement of buddy system skiing in fringe terrain.
 - Rope Tow skiing areas that are suitable for beginners.
 - Keep an eye out and assist less experienced skiers and tow users where possible.

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Briefing points that must be covered to the whole party (2/3)

- The correct and safe methods of mounting and dismounting the rope tow.
 - Mounting and Dismounting zones on the tow.
 - Tow Supervisors must ensure that until the previous person loaded gets at least one pole ahead, another person cannot be loaded.
- The daily Rope Tow Safety brief and what it means. (Actually discuss the report of the day!)
 - Also including who the Tow Operators and Supervisors are that day.
- “Helmets are not mandatory for usage of the BRC Rope Tow. Despite this, helmet usage is recommended while using the tow. This is in line with current practices at other ski fields operating a nutcracker ski tow.
- Names of all BRC rope tow users are to be recorded on the main whiteboard in the BRC dining room prior to usage.
- Carrying of Whistles by all tow users is mandatory, and this must be checked before users are allowed to ride the tow.
 - 3 blasts for an emergency.
 - Whistles are not to be used as a communication tool in non-emergency situations.
- Only registered winter party participants are to use the rope tow.

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Briefing points that must be covered to the whole party (3/3)

- “All safety incidents involving the rope tow must be recorded in alignment with the BRC standard practices.”
- Use of the Emergency Stop systems on the BRC rope tow.
- Tow Supervisor and Tow Operator roles and how these designated people work.
 - The rope tow controls are not to be operated by any persons who do not hold the Tow Operator training level.
 - The rope tow will never be operated until all weekly and daily checks have been completed, logged and signed off by the designated Tow Operator.
 - “The rope tow is specifically designed to comply with the standards set under Australian Law through the Canadian CSA Z98-2019 Rope Tow Standards.”
 - Carriage of radios by users is recommended, and the Designated Tow Operator will organise this.
 - At least one other radio must be used apart from the permanently installed Tow Hut one.
 - It is further recommended that all Designated Tow Supervisors have a radio at all times.
- When skiing the fringe terrain or beyond (marked red and then clear on the map), a minimum of 4 tow skiers applies, and the buddy system must be observed. When skiing in the unbounded (clear on map) area, a Trip Intention Form must be completed.
 - Tow Supervisors must also be put in place at each loading and unloading station.
- Maximum 6 Rope Tow riders (using the tow itself) at any given time.

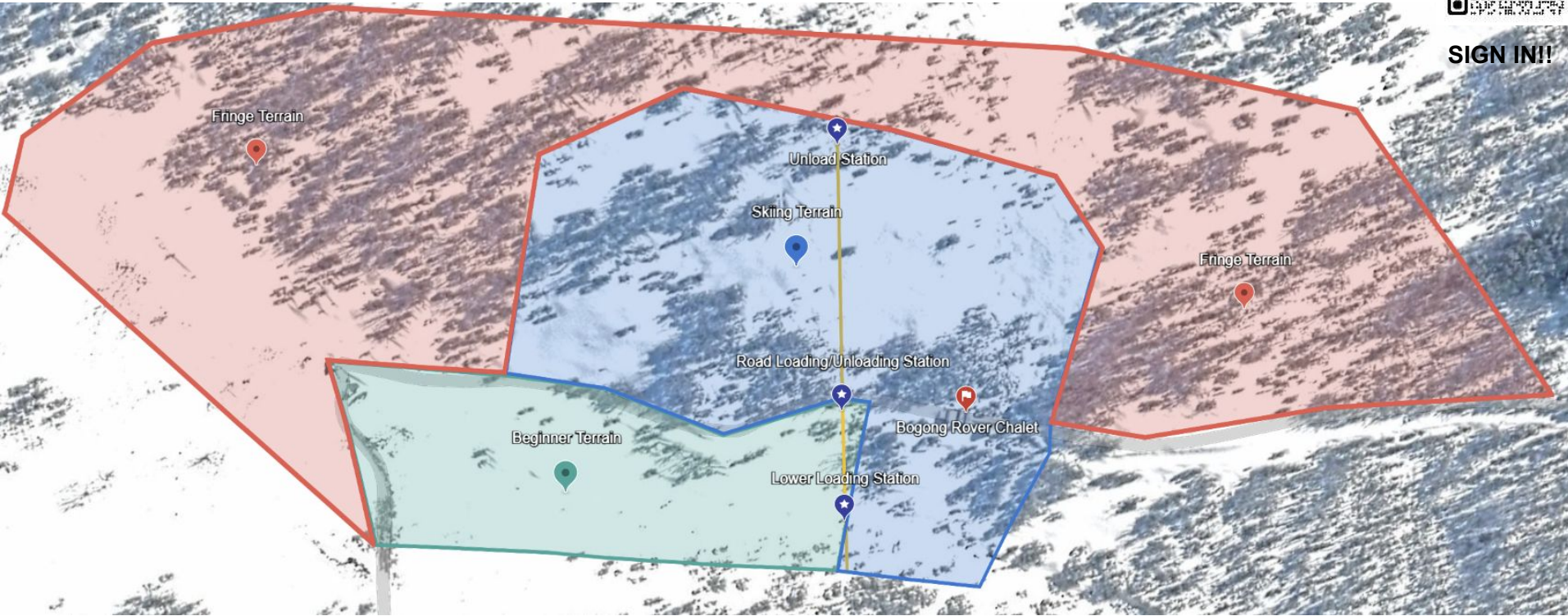
SIGN IN!!



Tow skiing/snowboarding area



SIGN IN!!



Green: Beginner Terrain | **Blue:** Advanced Terrain | **Red:** Fringe terrain
When skiing red/clear area, min. 4 skiers and buddy system. TIF for clear area.

Daily safety checks

For every day the tow gets used, a safety check must be done.

This is filled in on the logbook and then details copied to the Tow Leader's report.

Fill in prior to every day of tow use and at end of the day include the phone number of whoever records the rope check



Tow Hut Logbook

Please record all activity in the tow hut.

Week: -1	Tow Leader: <i>Oscar Hines</i>						
Weekly totals							
Fuel added to fuel tank	60L						
Oil added to sump	None						
Coolant added to radiator	None						
Total running hours for the week	14.2						
Start of day checks	Sat	Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri
Follow startup checklist	✓	✓	✓	✓			
Rope off hook and sitting on all wheels		✓	✓	✓			
Rope tensioned		✓	✓	✓			
Rope entry to tow hut clear of snow and ice		✓	✓	✓			
Oil level checked		✓	✓	✓			
Coolant level checked		✓	✓	✓			
Fuel level checked		✓	✓	✓			
Fuel tap open		✓	✓	✓			
E-Stops and safety gate tested and reset (x5)		✓	✓	✓			
Tow hut tidy		✓	✓	✓			
Initials of Designated Tow Operator		OH	JB	CJ			
End of day checks							
Follow shutdown checklist		✓	✓	✓			
Fuel tap closed		✓	✓	✓			
Control panel master key off		✓	✓	✓			
Battery isolators off		✓	✓	✓			
Rope hooked above road		✓	✓	✓			
Hour meter reading (total system time)		✓	✓	✓			
Initials of Designated Tow Operator		SE	CC	PR			
Issues, comments, rope inspection info, etc: <i>Rope good.</i> <i>Safety gate signage was damaged and replaced.</i> <i>Received start cutout warning on first start of each day.</i>							

SIGN IN!!



Checks for first and last use of season

Film 1 full rotation of the rope

- Must be stored on device for 30 days
- If we ask for it within 30 days, please send it. If not, you may delete
- Mark the rope with some ribbon or similar to see a full rotation through
- Check for any obvious breakage or significant wear

Put all signage out/in



SIGN IN!!



Tow signage

Signage is stored in this pink bag in the workshop, and spares in the extra folder in the tow hut.

This signage must go out to be compliant.

Locations of signage are described in the Pink Folder (also see next page)



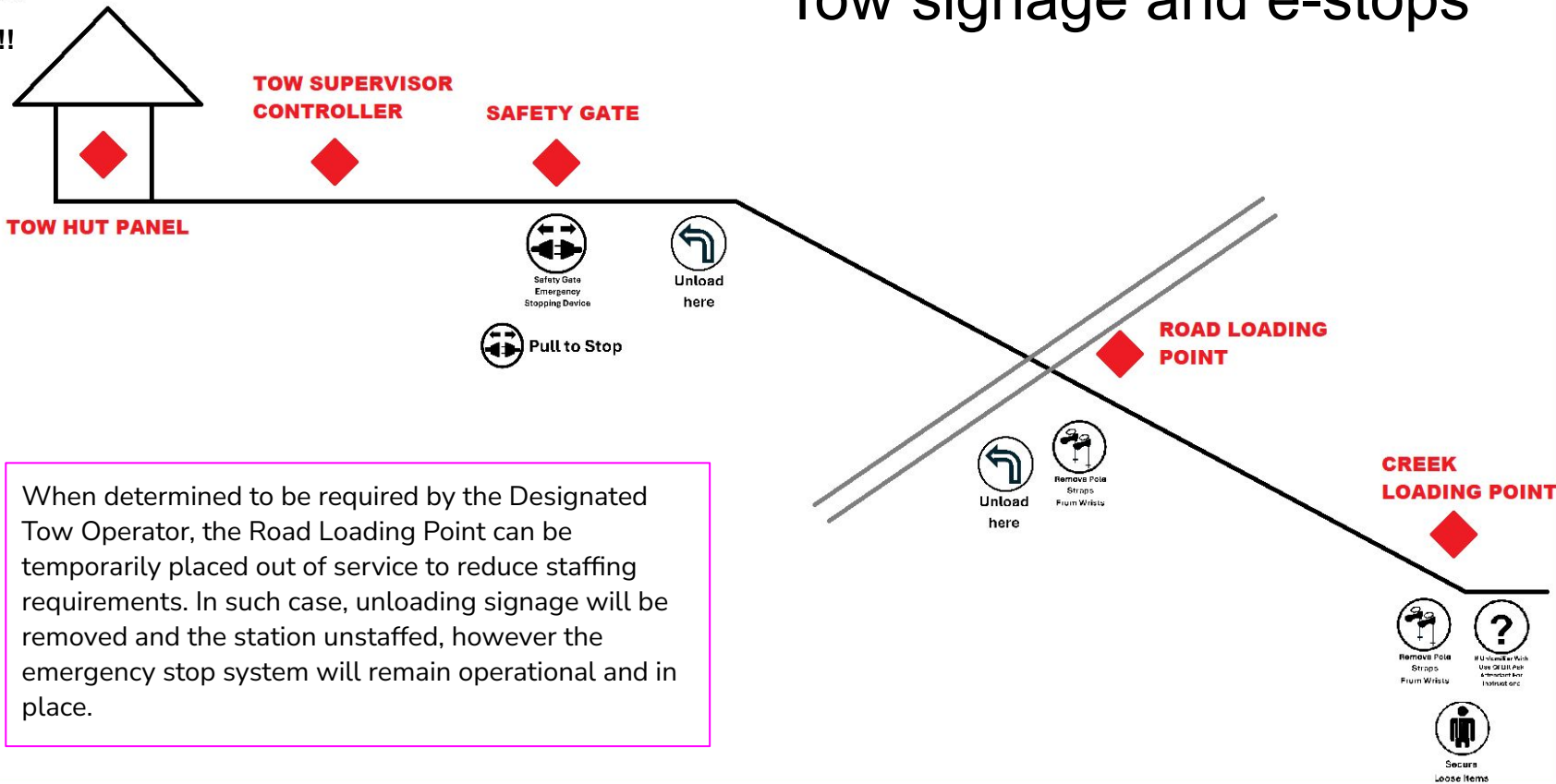
SIGN IN!!





SIGN IN!!

Tow signage and e-stops



When determined to be required by the Designated Tow Operator, the Road Loading Point can be temporarily placed out of service to reduce staffing requirements. In such case, unloading signage will be removed and the station unstaffed, however the emergency stop system will remain operational and in place.

Daily safety checks

Daily safety checks are fully documented in the *BRC Rope Tow Hut SOPs* found in the blue folder provided in the BRC and Tow Hut.

These checks should be documented in the BRC Rope Tow Logbook and copied to the BRC Tow Leader's report.

Bogong Rover Chalet Tow Hut SOPs



"Sidney and Oscar, new solar system 2026"

Version	Date	Editor	Revisions
DRAFT v1.0	28/02/2026	Oscar Hines	Initial publication
DRAFT v1.1	19/03/2026	Oscar Hines	New systems documented
DRAFT v1.2	07/04/2026	Oscar Hines	Final Draft
PUBLICATION v1.3	21/04/2026	Oscar Hines	Risk Management Practices

Contact information:

You are the Operator: Contact BCMG maintenance contact for issues. (Maintenance button on chalet phone.) Alternately, contact the BRC Warden.

You are the BCMG: Contact the BCMG Tow Email, tow@bogongroverchalet.org.au. This email address automatically forwards to Oscar Hines, Josh Bence and Matt Anderson.

SIGN IN!!



Safety checks before each use of the tow

- Fully detailed in the SOPs document -

- Building and plant checks, machinery guards
- Engine fluids
- Signage at all loading and unloading points
- Marking hazards on the slope with conduit (ski down)
- Sheave heights not greater than 1m above ground (account for short users!)
- Rope inspection for damage
- Emergency stop button operability test (lights on control panel)
- Slope conditions report (radio to chalet)

SIGN IN!!



Engine Safety Check

This is a responsibility of the Designated Tow Operator.

Pink tools are tow tools!

Log any problems, issues, or things to note in the logbooks provided

Only carry out repairs to the motor, drivetrain and electrical systems **if** given explicit permission by BCMG maintenance

The engine gauges should be monitored frequently during operation and the engine shut down if required



SIGN IN!!



Daily safety checks (end of session)

Hours of operation for the day

Road station made passable by elevating the rope

Ensure orange conduit is in place at road to alert any passing people of the tow

-> Complete the logbook actions and sign-off



SIGN IN!!



End of week safety checks

Ensure signage is in working order. If not, use the spares and make a suitable replacement.

Leave road markers

Rope elevated at the road



SIGN IN!!



End of the week

Finish your reports

Pack up e-stops

Pack up signage

Finalise any incident reports

Note down any competency promotions
(and demotions)

Let your TL know of any maintenance
issues for them to pass onto the head of
maintenance



SIGN IN!!



End of the week

Copy the information from the Tow Hut Logbook to the TL's report

Submit your tow leader report to the PL to send in as a NOB report

Competency promotions & demotions please hand write on the back of your report and submit



Bogong Rover Chalet
Tow Hut Logbook

Please record all activity in the tow hut

Activity	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31
Start of day checks																															
Follow startup checklist																															
Rope off hook and sitting on all wheels																															
Rope tensioned																															
Rope entry to tow hut clear of snow and ice																															
Oil level checked																															
Coolant level checked																															
Fuel level checked																															
Fuel tap open																															
Stops and safety gate tested and reset (x5)																															
Tow hut tidy																															
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Follow shutdown checklist																															
Fuel tap closed																															
Control panel master key off																															
Battery isolators off																															
Rope hooked above road																															
Hour meter reading (total system time)																															
Initials of Designated Tow Operator																															
Issues, comments, list of designated Tow Operators, date and time of Tow Trained User briefing:																															
Have you completed your incident reports?																															



Tow Leader Report

Send this with all other NOBs reports. Copy details from the tow hut logbook.

Week:	Tow Leader:						
Weekly totals							
Fuel added to fuel tank							
Oil added to sump							
Coolant added to radiator							
Total running hours for the week							
Start of day checks	Sat	Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri
Follow startup checklist							
Rope off hook and sitting on all wheels							
Rope tensioned							
Rope entry to tow hut clear of snow and ice							
Oil level checked							
Coolant level checked							
Fuel level checked							
Fuel tap open							
Stops and safety gate tested and reset (x5)							
Tow hut tidy							
Initials of Designated Tow Operator							
Follow shutdown checklist							
Fuel tap closed							
Control panel master key off							
Battery isolators off							
Rope hooked above road							
Hour meter reading (total system time)							
Initials of Designated Tow Operator							
Issues, comments, list of designated Tow Operators, date and time of Tow Trained User briefing:							
Have you completed your incident reports?							



	Training Provided	Other
23		
24		
25		
26		
27		
28		
29		
30		
31		
32		
33		
34		
35		



SIGN IN!!

Current Operational State

The Rope Tow is currently in a 3-year redevelopment & major works plan, with many automated features in the works to improve the ease of operation for inexperienced operators.

Not all planned features are functioning correctly, and as operators you need to be aware of these.

2026 Winter Inop Features

- Automatic engine shutdown protections
 - Monitor engine gauges every 15 minutes
 - Currently planned to be fixed this winter, will advise
- RPM & Oil temp gauge
 - Utilise other gauges and visual rope speed, 4th gear
- Automatic throttle and clutch
 - Operate manually
- Fire & CO detection
 - Keep doors open, frequent monitoring

FAQ

Can snowboarders use the tow? YES they're welcome to... try

Why do we film the rope before uses? To check for defects to the rope.

Can anyone use the tow? NO, only participants of that winter week

Can I use the tow on my own? YES, provided that all skiing is within the green and blue zones marked on the map, and a Tow Supervisor is in place on each Loading and Unloading Point. When skiing on the Fringe Terrain (marked in red on the map), or the unbounded area (marked clear on the map), a minimum of 4 tow skiers must be adhered to, and Fringe Terrain skiers must observe the buddy system.

If an individual participant doesn't want to ride the tow do they still have to attend the briefing? YES.

When does the oil need to be changed? You don't need to :)

SIGN IN!!



QUESTIONS?

SIGN IN!!



That's about it!!

- If you run into any troubles have any questions, doubts, or otherwise, remember that we're just a call away to help you out
- The safety of the Rope Tow operation is paramount
- We're currently midway through major upgrades to the Rope Tow systems so let us know if you have any feedback!
- Read the documentation prior to departure for your familiarisation
- We hope you have a lot of fun this year!



Sign in

Documentation

(Download and read this!!!)

